Ready Reference for Transcribing England and Wales Censuses

Including Channel Islands and Isle of Man

Spreadsheet Naming

The spreadsheet used as an input for CSVProc will have a two-part or three-part name.

- The first part will be the National Archives year identifier (e.g. HO107 or RG9 or RG10).

Note 1: For 1861 use RG9, not RG09.

- The second part will be the piece number. This will be preceded by an underscore (_). Please be aware that the "number is NOT an integer but the "number" assigned by the National Archives. It CAN be an alphanumeric e.g. 2345A. The Scottish suffices will be included in the number.
- The last part is optional. If used it will be a single letter preceded by an underscore (_). This is only used when a large piece is broken into smaller parts by the Coordinator and each part can be individually transcribed, proofread, validated and published. In that case the Coordinator will allocate the suffix to each part of the piece. The smallest unit that a Piece can be broken into is an Enumeration District (ED). If an ED is broken into smaller units it will create an Error when it is Published.

The file name will therefore look like this:
HO107_123.csv or
HO107_1234_a.csv or
RG9_2345.csv or
RG10_2370_a.csv.

Note 2: Do not enter the piece number in the spreadsheet. It is only to be used in the file name.

Column (Field) Types

There are several field types that are acceptable to CSVProc. You will find which type to use in the '**What Can Be Entered**' information in the Field Transcription Rules.

Valid field types are:

Number – Containing only the numbers 0 to 9 (e.g. 29).

Number and Suffix - Containing only the numbers 0 to 9 followed by a letter (e.g. 29a).

Special Entry – These will be defined for each relevant field in the field profile. CSVProc will test the field for the correct entry or pattern.

Narrow Text – Narrow Text permits any word character (letter, number, underscore) plus **, '**

Broad Text - Broad Text permits any word character (letter, number, underscore) plus **- ( ) . , & '**

Note: Do not use the / character or ? in a text field apart from the Notes field.

Field Transcription Rules

For the FreeCEN2 database to be fully searchable we all need to record the census information in the same way. Use the following guidelines to provide consistency.

If you find that entering (only) a hyphen in a cell does not work as expected, try using a Tab or Enter after the - . The entry of **'-** (single-quote hyphen) will create an Error in some fields. This is because '- is two characters and some fields are set to accept only one character, or because CSVProc is looking for – and '- does not match.

Whilst you are transcribing there will be occasions when you cannot read letters or words to transcribe them. In that case enter an underscore (_) or a series of underscores to indicate where the problem is. You will also need to set the appropriate query flag.

If you are transcribing Shipping Returns these guidelines should be read together with the shipping guidelines in the Handbook.

Enumeration District (ED) Information

Note: If any change is made in one of the fields in this Section (except the location flag) then all of the fields in the ED section must be re-entered. If this is not done CSVProc will report Errors.

Field name	**enumeration_district**
Column Contains	ED Number
Year/s Used	1841 - 1911
What Can Be Entered	Number or number and suffix or special entry

Description and Rules The ED number can be found on the cover sheet of each Enumerator's District. You only need to be entered it once at the start of each ED. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered.

Only enter the ED number once until it changes.

If there is no identifiable ED number then use 0 (zero).

Note 1: ED 1 may not necessarily be the first District of a Census Piece. If the suffix has been used by the Enumerator, you need to enter that suffix.

Note 2: If you enter an ED number in a row and leave the civil parish or subsequent fields in this Section blank this will create an Error in the CSVProc test report. It is therefore important that you only enter the ED number at the start of the ED, not at the start of every folio or page, unless one of the other fields in this Section changes.

Special Categories - Certain categories may feature in a piece but are not included on the 'normal' returns. These usually come at the end of the piece as different format reports without a record of Enumeration Number.

Use one of the following numbers as the relevant suffix:

1. Barracks & Military Quarters
2. HM Ships, at Home
3. Workhouses & Pauper Schools
4. Hospitals (Sick, Convalescent, Incurables)
5. Lunatic Asylums
6. Prisons
7. Certified Reformatory & Industrial Schools
8. Merchant Vessels & Lighthouses
9. Schools

For example, since no Enumeration District is identified on the pages a Workhouse would be entered as 0#3. *Note that you need to use the # sign.* There will be no Schedule Numbers: Use "0" (zero).

The schedules for Institutions & Shipping should be entered in the normal Folio Sequence

For Merchant Vessels, there may be no Page Numbers: Use "0" (zero)

"Relationship to Head" should follow the census detail ‘as is’ (e.g. 'Passenger').

Note 3: Some Institutions used a booklet in which each page has the individual lines numbered from 1 to 25: DO NOT type these numbers anywhere.

Note 4: For some Institutions it is not possible to maintain a 'normal' family grouping. For example, a Lighthouse Station which lists the staff first and then the various wives and children. Do not make any assumptions about relationships.

Field name civil_parish

Column Contains Civil Parish

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules The Civil Parish can either be found on the ED cover sheet or at the top left hand of each census page depending on the census year. Only enter it once at the beginning of an ED until it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered.

A blank or – (hyphen) is not an acceptable entry.

Note 1: If the enumerator has shown (part of) after the Civil Parish name do not transcribe (part of).

Note 2: The Civil Parish must be transcribed exactly as it is written in the Census, except for (part of), see Note 1. The entry will be tested against a reference file (PARMS file). For England and Wales, the PARMS file contains the Civil Parishes in each census piece as recorded by the National Archives (In FreeCEN2 for England and Wales the information was downloaded from the National Archives site). If the CSVProc test reports an Error that “the Civil Parish is not in the list of Civil Parishes” then the Transcriber should check their entry for correctness in the first instance.

If it looks correct make sure there are no additional full stops or commas included (e.g. Taunton St James entered as Taunton St. James). The TNA does not use full stops after abbreviations. If a full stop is used, CSVProc will report an Error.

If the transcription IS correct, then the Transcriber should advise their Coordinator. The Coordinator will then check the PARMS entry and if necessary, arrange for the PARMS file to be corrected. The issue will be notified to the National Archives so that the National Archives can amend their records.

Field name ecclesiastical_parish

Column Contains Ecclesiastical Parish

Year/s Used 1851 – 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules You will find this information can either on the ED cover sheet or at the top right hand of each census page depending on the census year.

The 1841 England and Wales census used the Hundred system. The Ecclesiastical Parish is not recorded in this census.

Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered.

If nothing is entered enter a – (hyphen) at the start of each ED.

Field name where_census_taken

Column Contains Where Census Taken

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules The place where the census was taken can be the name of the Island, Borough or Burgh, Municipal Borough, City, Town, Village, Hamlet or Tything. There are various options for the enumerator to record this information but only one was usually used for each place that the census was taken, depending on the circumstances. In 1841 it may have been recorded as a County Corporate.

In England and Wales the Islands and Boroughs are usually found on the cover sheet of an ED. Towns, Villages, Hamlets and Tythings are usually found at the top of each census page. If more than one option is provided enter only the smallest in size.

Recording the information in this field eliminates the need to capture it in the address unless it has also been entered in the address column by the enumerator.

For Shipping, enter the Position of Vessel in this field. This may be shown in the form of Latitude and Longitude. See the Handbook.

Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered.

Note: A blank or – (hyphen) is not an acceptable entry.

Field name ward

Column Contains Ward

Year/s Used 1861 – 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules You will find this on the ED Cover sheet. In 1861 the information was often blank.

If nothing is entered, enter a – (hyphen) at the start of each ED

Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered.

Field name parliamentary_constituency

Column Contains Parliamentary Constituency

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules You can usually find this on the ED Cover sheet. In some years it is recorded on each census page. The information may have been recorded as Parliamentary District.

Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered.

The information was often left blank in the earlier censuses. In this case enter a – (hyphen) at the start of each ED.

Field name sanitary_district

Column Contains Sanitary District

Year/s Used 1871 – 1891

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules You can find this on the ED Cover sheet for England and Wales. In 1871 it was called the Local Board of Commissioners and in 1881 and 1891 it was called the Urban or Rural Sanitary District.

If the information has not been recorded enter a – (hyphen) at the start of each ED.

Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered.

Field name location_flag

Column Contains ED Query Flag

Year/s Used All censuses

What Can Be Entered x or X or blank

Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about an ED entry being 'as is' they should enter a flag here.

Household Information

Field name folio_number

Column Contains Folio Number

Year/s Used 1841 – 1901

What Can Be Entered Number

Description and Rules This is the number stamped at the top of every second page in the Enumerator's Book. Folio Numbers start from 1 at the beginning of a Piece and occur on every odd numbered page except 1841 where it appears on every even numbered page. It progressively increases regardless of changes to the Enumeration District.

Sometimes pages were missed (the number may have been pencilled in later) or even whole books may not have been numbered. Suffix letters are very rarely found. If a Folio Number is missing from its normal position DO NOT type zero. Leave it out unless you can work it out from the page numbers.

Only enter this number each time that it changes.

Note: If the transcription of a folio number is repeated against each page in the folio it will create a Warning when the piece is tested by CSVProc.

In 1911 there are no folio numbers as the returns were not transcribed into an enumerator's book.

Field name page_number

Column Contains Page number

Year/s Used 1841 - 1901

What Can Be Entered Number

Description and Rules The Page Number is preprinted on the Census Pages (except for Shipping Returns) and generally you will find this in the top right corner or top left corner of each page in the enumerator's book.

Only enter this number each time that it changes.

In 1911 there are no page number as the returns were not transcribed into an enumerator's book.

For Merchant Vessels, there may be no Page Numbers: Use "0" (zero)

Field name schedule_number

Column Contains Schedule number

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Number and a suffix

Description and Rules Enter the number that is enumerated in the census. A suffix is entered only if it is present on the Census page. It is usually in the form of an alpha character (e.g. 69a) or a fraction (e.g. 69 1/2) *Note the space between the number and the fraction*.

You MUST enter a value for every New Household or empty premises. If no other value can be found, then enter 0 (zero). Enter the schedule number only once for each family, against the first entry in the family. In the testing routine this column provides the 'trigger' to recognise each separate household or building.

Care should be taken if the Enumerator has entered two separate families, each with its own "Head", under a single address. You will see that families are separated by an enumerators tick, either / or //. A / means a new family same address whilst // means a new family at a new address. You can therefore re-enter the address for families with an / immediately before them, but not for a // as this is a different building. Each family should be given a schedule number 0 (zero) if the enumerator has not given them a schedule number and an enumerator's tick exists.

In 1851 families were separated by a ruled line after each family. Where more than one family shared a house there was a single line starting on the left-hand side of the third column. A single line was drawn across the page as far as the last column was placed after the last occupant in the building.

In 1841 schedule numbers were not used. You must therefore give each new family a schedule number of 0 (zero).

The schedule number **must only** be entered once for each family and against the first person in the family.

Note 1: Occasionally the enumerator entered the schedule number on the incorrect line. Use the enumerator's ticks to identify the first entry of the household and move the schedule number there.

Note 2: Sometimes 2 schedule numbers are recorded against the same family (e.g.5 and 6). In this case the schedule number can be entered as 5&6 (Note no space). No flag is necessary.

Field name uninhabited_flag

Column Contains Unoccupied

Year/s Used 1841 - 1901

What Can Be Entered u, b, n, v or blank

Description and Rules This is used where a schedule has no family attached to it:

- enter b if this is shown on the Census Sheet (Building in progress)
- enter u if this is shown on the Census Sheet (Unoccupied)
- enter v if the Census Sheet indicates "family away or visiting"
- enter n to show that the enumerator has shown that the schedule was not used.

Note: This is not case sensitive.

Where the enumerator has not entered a schedule number, enter a schedule number of 0 (zero).

Where an entry such as 3u has been entered by the enumerator, make three entries on the spreadsheet, one for each unoccupied building.

Enumerator's sometimes skipped a schedule number. In this case n should be entered against that schedule number to show it was not enumerated. You need to be sure that it does not appear elsewhere in the ED.

Where b, u, v or n has been entered in this field then no information is required on the rest of the row beyond the address. If the enumerator has supplied additional information, enter it in the Notes column.

Sometimes the u or b is entered beside a family by the enumerator. Where it is not clear where it actually belongs the u or b can be entered on the spreadsheet either before or after the schedule containing the family.

Note 1: In the England and Wales census for 1901, columns 3, 4, 5 and 6 show whether the house was occupied. If there is a tick in column 4 then enter 'v' (i.e. the house is usually occupied but is uninhabited – in other words, the family is away). If there is a tick in column 5 the house is unoccupied and uninhabited, so enter 'u'. If there is a tick in building enter 'b'. In each case if there is no schedule number entered then give it a schedule number of 0 (zero).

Note 2: Whilst this field is called an uninhabited_flag it is not a query flag. The address_flag should be used for queries.

Field name house_number

Column Contains House Number

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Number or number plus suffix or fraction or blank

Description and Rules This is the house number recorded as part of the address on the census page. If no house number has been recorded leave this field blank.

Only enter this once for each schedule and on the same row as the schedule number.

Note: This field will accept a range of entries. 1&2, 1-3, 1/21, 3A etc. are all acceptable as long as the entry starts with a number. There is no longer the need to move some of the information into the house_or_street_name column.

Field name house_or_street_name

Column Contains Address

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank

Description and Rules This is the rest of the address recorded on the census page. If there is no address recorded leave this field blank.

Note 1: If the enumerator only puts the address at the top of each page, always read the Enumerators info page at the start of each new ED. This will tell you the route they were told to take.(not always helpful). Sometimes it is very obvious that because he wrote his route he often just entered the address at the top of each page. If he did not do that, and there is any doubt then please stick to the 'as is' rule.

For Shipping Returns enter the name of the Vessel and the home port in this field. See the Handbook.

Only enter this information once for each schedule and on the same row as the schedule number.

Note 2: In the England and Wales 1911 census, the address is entered twice, once on the main sheet next to the resident's signature and also on the cover sheet. Sometimes the two addresses are different, but similar; In this case combine them into an address that provides the most appropriate information to the researcher.

Field name rooms

Column Contains No. Rooms

Year/s Used 1901 and 1911

What Can Be Entered Number or blank

Description and Rules You will find this in column 7 of the 1901 census and at the bottom of the census page in the 1911 census. Only enter this once for each schedule on the same row as the schedule number. If there is nothing recorded leave it blank.

Note: Entries over 20 rooms will produce a Warning as a way of highlighting unusual entries so that they can be verified by the Validator. In the 1901 England and Wales census this Warning will occur where the entry is over 4 rooms as the census asked for the number of rooms where it was less than 5.

Field name address_flag

Column Contains Address Query

Year/s Used All censuses

What Can Be Entered x or X or blank

Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about a household entry being 'as is' they should enter a flag here.

Individual Information

Field name surname

Column Contains Surname

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text

Description and Rules Enter this for each person in the family. It should be entered 'as is' even if it is known to be wrong. Enter a - (hyphen) if no surname is enumerated.

Note: If the surname has been enumerated with an accent (e.g. e acute or e grave). Enter the non-accented letter. Letters with accents are not within the character set.

Field name forenames

Column Contains Forenames

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text

Description and Rules Enter this for each person in the family. Forenames should be entered 'as is' even if they are known to be wrong. Enter a – (hyphen) if no forename is enumerated. Infant is an acceptable forename.

A name, or - (hyphen), MUST be entered for every person. Allow a space between names, initials, or words. Titles are to be typed after forenames, enclosed in brackets/braces as in (Rev), (Dr), (Prof) etc. In an extreme case "Elizabeth (Lady Chalfont)" is covered by this rule.

Note: If the forename has been enumerated with an accent (e.g. e acute or e grave), you will need to enter the non-accented letter. Letters with accents are not within the character set.

Field name name_flag

Column Contains Name Query

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered x or X or blank

Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about a name entry being 'as is' they should enter a flag here.

Field name relationship

Column Contains Relationship

Year/s Used 1851 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text or blank

Description and Rules Enter the relationship to the head in full in this column. This is found on each schedule. Relationship should follow the census detail (e.g. 'Passenger') 'as is'.

Where no relationship is recorded leave the field blank. Do NOT make assumptions.

There is no need to try to correct a Relationship in the Notes column. It is up to the researcher to interpret the information in the census.

Field name marital_status

Column Contains Marital Status

Year/s Used 1851 - 1911

What Can Be Entered m, s, u, w, d, - or blank

Description and Rules Enter a single letter from the list below:

- M Married
- S Single
- U Unmarried
- w Widow
- d Divorced

as shown on the Census Page for each person. If the Enumerator left it blank leave the field blank. Do NOT make assumptions.

Any other letter other than these will be rejected as invalid.

Note: '- cannot be entered as a hyphen. It will create an error report. A - must be used.

Field name sex

Column Contains Sex

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered m, f or -

Description and Rules The Census Page has two columns for "Age", Male and Female. FreeCEN reduces this to a single letter m or f or -.

If the age columns are empty, then enter - (hyphen). Do not make assumptions.

Note 1: Some Enumerators were careless, writing "Robert, son" or "Jane, dau" and then filling the age in the incorrect column. In these instances, use the gender that matches the relationship, and enter a note "Age in wrong column" in the notes. There is no need to enter a query flag. This note will eventually appear in the database for the researcher to see.

Note 2: A blank is not an acceptable entry.

Note 3: '- cannot be entered as a hyphen. It will create an error report. A - must be used.

Field name age

Column Contains Age

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Up to three numerals and one letter (y, m, w or d) or Complex age (see below)

Description and Rules The Census Page has two columns for "Age", Male and Female. You MUST enter a number for each person. Zero is not acceptable.

If the age is blank then enter 999 **without entering** a query flag *(Enter 999 not 999y)*.

If the age is unreadable enter 999 **and** enter a query flag *(Enter 999 not 999y)*.

Ignore fractions. If an age is enumerated as 1½ months enter 1m in the age and enter “age enumerated as 1½ months” in the Notes column. Do **not** set a query flag when this happens.

If the census states "less than 1 month" then enter 1m and enter a note in the Notes field. Do not leave spaces between numbers and the letter. Do **not** set a query flag when this happens.

Standard Rules for Age

- If only a number is entered, it will be converted as 'years'. E.g. 46 or 46y will be converted to mean "46 Years". y (Years) minimum value = 1, maximum value = 120
- m (Months) minimum value = 1m, maximum value = 24m
- w (Weeks) minimum value = 1w, maximum value = 20w
- d (Days) minimum value = 1d, maximum value =30d
- If marital Status is M or W, then the male age must not be less than 14y or the female age not less than 12y.

You can enter Complex ages. For instance, if a child has been enumerated as 1 week 3 days it is not necessary to amend this to 10 days. You can enter the age as 1w 3d *(note the space between the entries)*. The transcription must still comply with the above rules for limits of both the weeks and days.

Any values outside the above guidelines will create Warning or Error messages when the transcription is tested.

Field name years_married

Column Contains Years Married

Year/s Used 1911 only

What Can Be Entered Number or Complex number or blank

Description and Rules Enter the value as shown in the census. Enter it only once for each married couple next to the female member of the family, usually enumerated as wife. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

Standard Rules for Years Married

- If only a number is entered, it will be converted as 'years'. E.g. 26 or 26y will be converted to mean "26 Years".
- y (Years) minimum value = 1, maximum value = 99
- m (Months) minimum value = 1m, maximum value = 12m
- w (Weeks) minimum value = 1w, maximum value = 4w
- d (Days) minimum value = 1d, maximum value =7d

Any values outside the above guidelines will create Warning or Error messages when the transcription is tested.

If a duration is enumerated as 1½ years enter 1y 6m *(note the space between the entries)* and enter “years married enumerated as 1½ years” in the Notes column. Do **not** set a query flag when this happens.

If the census states "less than 1 year" then enter 1 or 1y and enter a note in the Notes field. Do **not** set a query flag when this happens.

You can enter Complex years married. For instance, if a marriage has been enumerated as 1 year 3 months, you can enter this as 1y 3m *(note the space between the entries).* The transcription must still comply with the above rules for limits of both the years and months.

Note: Where the years married has been crossed out but is legible, record it with a note in the Notes field that the entry has been crossed out. Do not set a flag.

Field name children_born_alive

Column Contains Children Born Alive

Year/s Used 1911 only

What Can Be Entered Number or blank

Description and Rules Enter the value as shown in the census as children born alive. The value should appear next to a female member of the family, usually enumerated as wife. It should be entered in the same row as that person. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

Note 1: It is generally accepted that the maximum number of children that one woman can give birth to is 15 (though there are records of a greater number). Therefore, if the number of children born alive is greater than 15 it will generate a Warning and the entry will be verified at Validation.

Note 2: Where the children born alive has been crossed out but is legible, record it with a note in the Notes field that the entry has been crossed out. Do not set a flag.

Field name children_living

Column Contains No. Living

Year/s Used 1911 only

What Can Be Entered Number or blank

Description and Rules Enter the value as shown in the census as children still living. The value should appear next to a female member of the family. It should be entered in the same row as that person. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

Field name children_deceased

Column Contains No. Deceased

Year/s Used 1911 only

What Can Be Entered Number or blank

Description and Rules Enter the value as shown in the census as children deceased. The value should appear next to a female member of the family, usually enumerated as wife.

If no information has been provided, then leave blank.

Field name individual_flag

Column Contains Individual Query

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered x or X or blank

Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about any of the individual information being 'as is' they should enter a flag here.

Employment Information

Field name occupation

Column Contains Occupation

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank

Description and Rules Transcribe the occupation exactly as enumerated in the census. Do not correct spellings.

In 1841 there were standard abbreviations for particular occupations. These abbreviations should be expanded to their full meanings. A table of 1841 abbreviations can be found in the Handbook.

Note 1: When the original censuses were enumerated statistics were extracted from them. The person who extracted the statistics was not necessarily the enumerator. The person doing the statistics would sometimes cross through the occupation to show that it had been counted and would write the statistical category over it. For instance, Baker overwritten with "Bread maker"; Carter on farm overwritten with "Horse"; Flax spinner overwritten with "Linen". Transcribe the original enumerator's entry.

Note 2: Transcription of 'Scholar' is now a Warning and not an Error. If the enumerator has entered 'Scholar' then it should be transcribed 'as is'. It does not need changing.

Field name industry

Column Contains Industry

Year/s Used 1911 only

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank

Description and Rules Transcribe the industry exactly as shown in the census. This information was often left blank.

Field name occupation_category

Column Contains Employment Status

Year/s Used 1891 – 1911

What Can Be Entered e, r, n or blank

Description and Rules In 1891 the Census form shows three columns to be marked if the person was "Employer", "Employee", or "Neither". FreeCEN Transcribes this information into a single column. Do not make assumptions if these columns are all empty.

Enter r for "employeR"; e for "employeE"; n only when marked as "Not employer/employee"

If a person is marked for both "employeR" and "employeE" enter r.

In 1901 the census changes to Employer, Worker or Own Account. Enter r for EmployeR; e for Worker; and n for Own Account.

Field name at_home

Column Contains At Home

Year/s Used 1901 – 1911

What Can Be Entered h or blank

Description and Rules From 1901 the Census form includes a column to be completed if the person is working from home. Enter an h in this column if 'At Home' has been entered on the census. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

Field name occupation_flag

Column Contains Occupation Query

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered x or X or blank

Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about any of the occupation information being 'as is' they should enter a flag here.

Birth Information

Field name verbatim_birth_County

Column Contains Chapman Code (CHP)

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Valid Chapman Code

Description and Rules The verbatim_chapman_County and the verbatim_birth_place together make up the Place of Birth. Enter the County as a Chapman Code and the rest of the place of birth is entered as text in the verbatim_birth_place.

The Chapman Code sub-group caters for all UK Chapman Codes. Chapman codes are a set of 3-letter codes used in genealogy to identify the administrative divisions in the United Kingdom, Ireland, the Isle of Man and the Channel Islands.

Overseas entries are coded OVB where the person was born in one of the British Empire countries of the time or is stated to be a British Subject. OVF is used for all other Foreign birth places.

Use UNK only as a last resort. Unless there can be no doubts, type only what is written on the census page: "Brighton" is in SSX; "Cambridge" (with no other clue) could refer either to the city or to the County. It would therefore be entered as Chapman Code CAM and POB – (hyphen). Another example is Newport with no County enumerated. Newports can be found in MON, NRY, PEM, DEV, SOM, GLS, CON and SAL plus several other Counties and therefore the Chapman Code should be recorded as UNK.

Where a Place of Birth is recorded as place, county, and country (e.g. Edinburgh, Midlothian, Scotland) enter the Chapman Code for Midlothian and the place of birth as Edinburgh. Midlothian is by default in Scotland. Therefore, do not type Scotland here as it makes searching for the right record harder for the researcher.

If the enumerator entered the Place of Birth as just Ireland, for instance, transcribe this as IRL - (hyphen) **not** as IRL Ireland. IRL Ireland will create a Warning when the piece is tested.

The 1841 Census requires different treatment since the information is merely "Born In This County? Yes/No". Permitted entries will be limited to the Chapman Code for "this County" or OUC (where born Out of County), IRL, SCT, OVF or UNK.

A table of valid Chapman Codes appears in the Handbook.

Note: If a Chapman Code that is not in the table is entered, or the field is left blank, it will create an Error when the piece is tested by CSVProc.

Field name verbatim_birth_place

Column Contains POB

Year/s Used 1851 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or – (hyphen)

Description and Rules Enter the Place of Birth that is written on the Census Page including any misspellings.

If you believe it to be incorrectly spelt or the County to be incorrect you can enter your suggestion in the birth_County and birth_place columns *(Note: both columns must be completed)*. **There is no need to enter a flag**. The Validator will review this entry at Validation.

Sometimes a place of birth is entered as a smaller place followed or preceded by the name of a larger nearby place. **Always** show the name of the larger place first.

Where a place of birth has been shown as a town with a parish then enter the town name followed by the parish irrespective of the order on the census page (e.g. St Pauls Bristol becomes Bristol St Pauls).

If born overseas such as "Notre Dame, Paris, France"; then enter "OVF" in the verbatim_birth_County and rearrange the place "France, Paris, Notre Dame".

If in doubt, follow the larger to smaller guideline.

Note 1: It is extremely important that you follow the larger to smaller rule. CSVProc tests the Place of Birth against the Place Names in the Place Names Database. If a Place of Birth is enumerated as St Pauls Bristol and you do not change the order the Place of Birth will not be matched with a place that we have in the database and a Warning will be generated. If you change it to Bristol St Pauls CSVProc will find it in the database and pass it without a Warning. CSVProc is looking for an exact match.

There are some specific cases.

If the place of birth is enumerated only as London enter LND in the Chapman Code and – (hyphen) in the Place of Birth.

If, for example, "Scotland" is all that has been written; enter "SCT" as the Chapman Code and a – (hyphen) in this column.

Note 2: If the place of birth has been enumerated with an accent (e.g. e acute or e grave), enter the non-accented letter. Letters with accents are not within the character set.

Note 3: '- cannot be entered as a hyphen. It will create a Warning report. A - must be used.

Field name nationality

Column Contains Nationality Details

Year/s Used 1851 – 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text or blank

Description and Rules Information such as 'Naturalised' or 'British Subject' is entered here. In 1911 the census also asked for information for people born overseas such as when Naturalised or Nationality gained by parentage. In 1911 the entry may look like "Naturalised 1889". Enter the information 'as is'. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

From 1851 to 1901 notes such as 'British Subject' were added to the census by the enumerator, usually in the margin. Enter these notes in this column.

Note: We have included this column on most England and Wales spreadsheets to provide a space for nationality notes provided by some enumerators (e.g. British Subject).

Field name birth_county

Column Contains Alternative Chapman Code

Year/s Used All censuses

What Can Be Entered Valid Chapman Code or blank

Description and Rules The Transcriber and / or Proofreader and / or the Validator can put their own choice of Chapman Code in this column. For example, if the enumerator has entered Bath Wiltshire the verbatim transcription would show WIL Bath. Bath is in Somerset so SOM can be entered in this column, but Bath MUST be re-entered in the birth_place column.

A table of Chapman Codes appears in the Handbook.

Note: When a suggestion has been made for the alternative entry by the Transcriber or Proofreader a Warning will appear on the testing report so that the Validator can validate the entry.

Field name birth_place

Column Contains Alternative Place of Birth

Year/s Used 1851 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text or hyphen (-) or blank

Description and Rules The Transcriber and / or Proofreader and / or the Validator can put their own choice of Place of Birth in this column.

For example, if the enumerator has entered Bridgewater Somerset the original transcription would show SOM Bridgewater. Bridgewater has been mis-spelt; it should be Bridgwater. Therefore, enter Bridgwater in this column and you must re-enter SOM in the birth_county column.

If in doubt, follow the larger to smaller guideline.

Note 1: '- cannot be entered as a hyphen. It will create a Warning report. A - must be used.

Note 2: When a suggestion has been made for the alternative entry by the Transcriber or Proofreader a Warning will appear on the testing report so that the Validator can validate the entry.

Field name father_place_of_birth

Column Contains Birthplace of Father

Year/s Used Channel Islands 1911 only

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank

Description and Rules Enter the information exactly as it is shown on the census form. There is no need to enter a Chapman code and place of birth in separate columns, enter all the information in this column. If no information has been provided leave blank.

Note: In some cases, the father's place of birth has been enumerated with an accent (e.g. e acute or e grave). In this case enter the non-accented letter. Letters with accents are not within the character set.

Field name place_birth_flag

Column Contains POB Query

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered x or X or blank

Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about any of the place of birth information being 'as is' they should enter a flag here.

Do not enter a flag if you have entered an alternative in the birth_county and birth_place columns. It will automatically be displayed at Validation.

Miscellaneous Information

Field name disability

Column Contains Disability

Year/s Used 1851 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank

Description and Rules Different censuses asked for different information here. Sometimes enumerators entered information beyond what was asked for. Enter the disability as enumerated. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

In 1911 the information was recorded as infirmity on the census form.

Field name disability_notes

Column Contains Disability Notes

Year/s Used 1911 only

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank

Description and Rules In 1911 the question was asked for more information about disability, such as when the disability started etc. Enter this information here. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

Field name language

Column Contains Language

Year/s Used Wales 1891 – 1911; Isle of Man 1911

What Can Be Entered Up to 2 letters or blank

Description and Rules In many censuses there was a question about language. This occurred in Wales and the Isle of Man. Enter the appropriate letter or letters for the language spoken here. Leave this entry blank if it has not been filled in on the census.

Use a code from the list below:

- E English
- G Gaelic
- GE Gaelic and English
- I Irish
- IE Irish and English
- M Manx
- ME Manx and English
- W Welsh
- WE Welsh and English

If you are using the England and Wales spreadsheet for a County that is not in Wales or the Isle of Man leave this column blank.

Note: If the language is enumerated as Both transcribe the appropriate double entry from the list above. Do not use B as it will produce an Error when tested by CSVProc.

Notes

Field name notes

Column Contains Notes

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank

Description and Rules Enter any messages that you need to explain a query flag here.

Notes not belonging in any field can be allowed to appear in the FreeCEN database for researchers to see. These notes may be such as “age unclear” as a reason for a query or Birth Registration details where a name has been unable to be deciphered and the Transcriber or Proofreader has researched the entry.

This is the only text field in which a / can be used, so that entries such as 1/2 can be made.

This is the only text field in which a ? can be used

For Shipping Returns enter the tonnage, Ship description and trade in this field. See the Handbook.